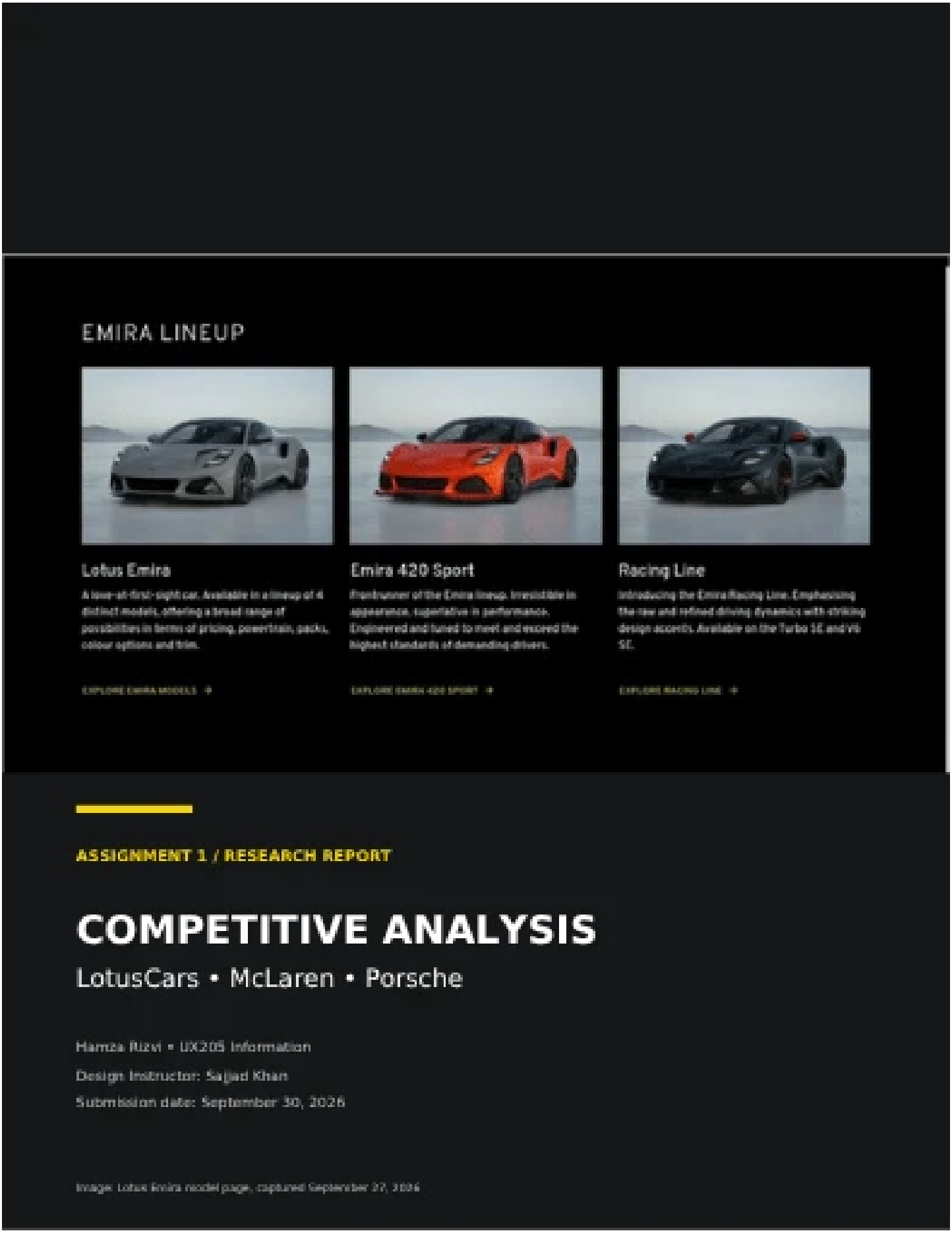
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Scope and method

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Why these competitors?

McLaren is a focused, high-performance marque with a comparable model-to-configure-to-retailer journey. Porsche offers a broader luxury/performance range and a more explicit model comparison flow. Both provide useful alternatives for testing how Lotus could organize model choices and ownership tasks. The websites serve different markets here: McLaren UK English and Porsche Canada English.

Tasks performed

- Find a current performance model and understand its key differences from another variant.
- Find a route to configuration and then an authorized retailer or centre.
- Locate ownership/support information and note visible social or customer feedback paths.

Evaluation lens

Expert desktop walkthrough on September 27, 2026; observed page content, navigation labels, task paths and accessible DOM. Pricing was assessed as information visibility, not a quote. Mobile layouts, screen readers and purchase flows were not formally tested.



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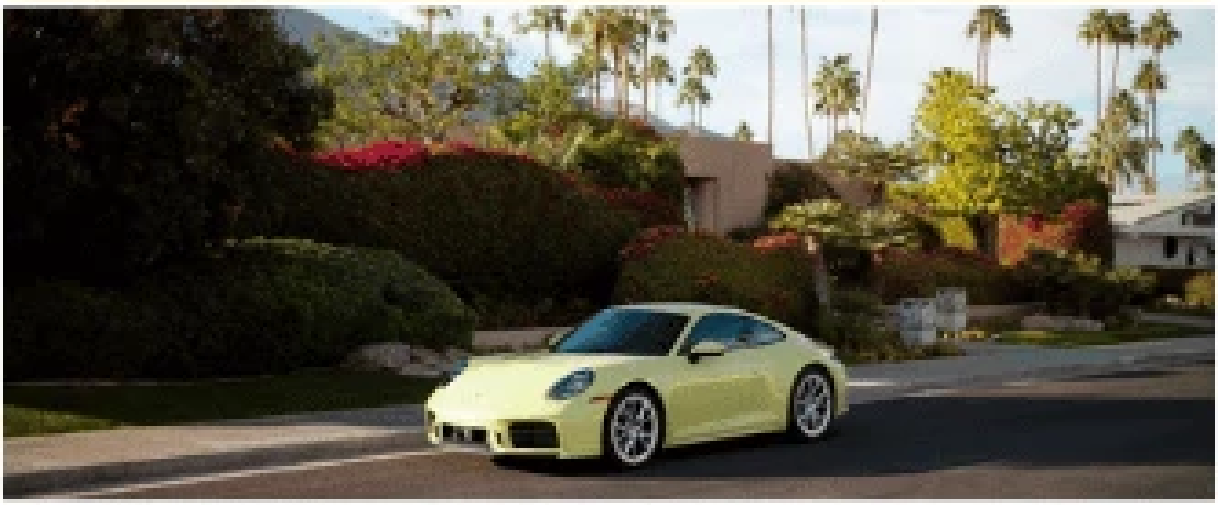
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Comparison checklist • offering

Criterion	McLaren Automotive		Porsche Canada	
Products / features	Supercars, grand tourers and hypercars; current model cards link to Explore, Configure or Enquire.		Sports cars, EVs, SUVs and sedans; 911 variants show technical highlights, Configure and Compare.	
Pricing	No starting price on the sampled Supercars list; a buyer moves to configuration or retailer enquiry for cost.		The 911 comparison tool shows Canadian "From" prices with specifications; model overview cards prioritize performance data.	
Pages sampled	Homepage; current Supercars; 750S route; retailer and ownership links.		Homepage; 911 overview; 911 comparison; Porsche Finder and Centre Search.	
Usability	Compact, clear category tabs and two actions per model; model rows are spacious, though the list does not compare specifications.		Filters, variant cards and checkboxes support comparison; 23 visible 911 choices may take more effort to scan.	
Visual design	Editorial photography, restrained white/black palette, large vehicles and minimal text.		Modular cards, clear data hierarchy and visible model photos; denser but more decision-oriented.	
Findability / IA	Top-level Supercars / Grand Tourers / Hypercars / Motorsport; retailer is in header; ownership is deeper.		Model families, filters, Compare and Configure form a structured shopping path; support is spread across services.	

What this means for Lotus

McLaren shows the value of a focused model taxonomy; Porsche shows the value of side-by-side specifications. Lotus can combine an emotional first view with a clear comparison step before configuration.



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Comparison checklist • experience

Criterion	McLaren Automotive	Porsche Canada
Accessibility	A "Skip to main content" link and labelled model links were visible in the sampled DOM. Large moving homepage media merits motion/contrast testing. No WCAG conformance claim.	Model filters, card headings and Compare controls had accessible names in sampled DOM. Dense filters and image fallback labels merit mobile/screen-reader review. No WCAG conformance claim.
Responsive / app	Desktop was reviewed; mobile layout formally tested. Car configuration opens a separate tool.	Desktop was reviewed; mobile layout tested. My Porsche app is promoted on vehicle pages.
Marketing	Brand film, heritage narratives, bespoke MSO, experiences and newsletter prompt.	Featured campaigns, driving experiences, financial offers, personalization and inventory discovery.
Social media	Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, X and LinkedIn links appear in the sampled footer.	Porsche social channels exist, but they were not part of the model-selection task path reviewed.
Reviews / support	Customer reviews were not shown in the sampled model list; retailer, contact, roadside and service paths are available.	Customer reviews were not shown in the sampled model cards; Centre Search, Finder and alternates paths are available.
Strengths	Focused range, polished storytelling and clear Configure action.	Strong product filtering, technical data, starting-price visibility in Compare, dealer/inventory ecosystem.
Weaknesses / openings	Feature comparison and price context are limited in the sampled list.	Broad inventory and many variants increase choice load; top-level model information can feel dense.

Accessibility standard
Use WCAG 2.2 as a review framework for non-text alternatives, semantic information, keyboard access, focus, contrast and headings. Observations above are a limited walkthrough.

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McLaren • focused range

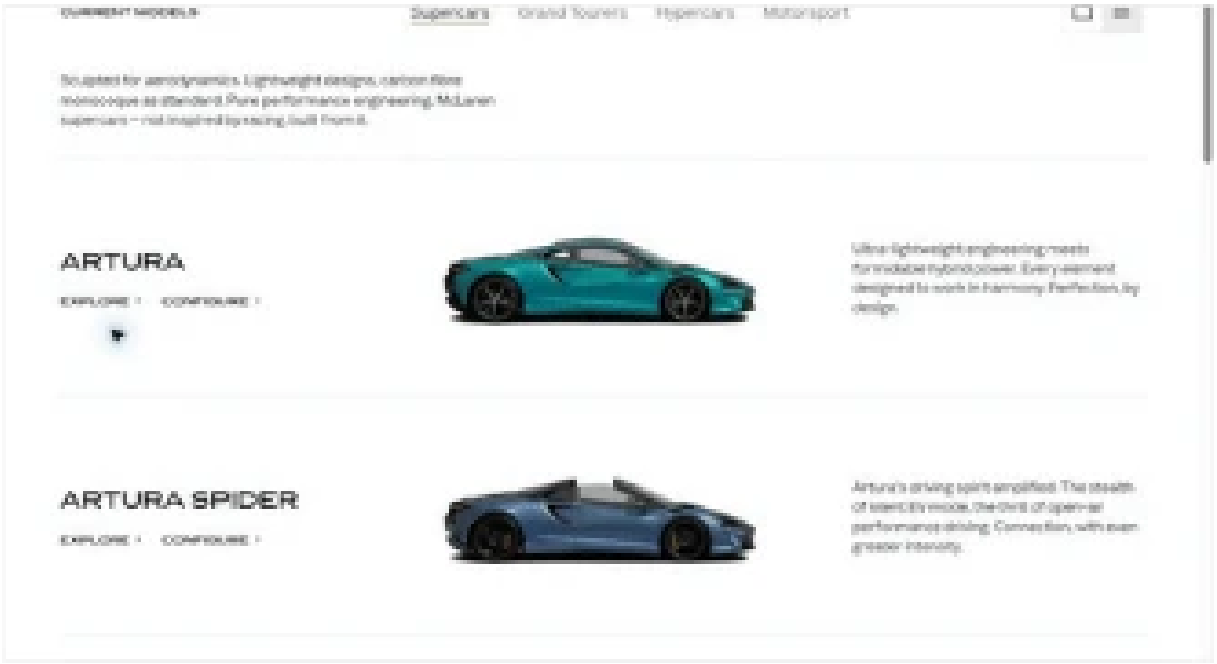


Figure 1. Current Supercars list: category tabs, spacious vehicle rows and Explore/Configure links. Screenshot captured September 27, 2026.

SWOT snapshot

Strength	Concise range labels and direct Configure action.
Weakness	The sampled list offers little aligned specification or price context.
Opportunity	A Lotus comparison could join narrative pages to decision data.
Threat	High-production imagery and bespoke options set user expectations for premium visual quality.

Task observation

On the list view, a visitor can switch model categories and move to Artura or 750S pages quickly. The next decision—how two models differ requires additional page visits. The visible "Find a Retailer" link creates an obvious handoff.

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Porsche • comparison system

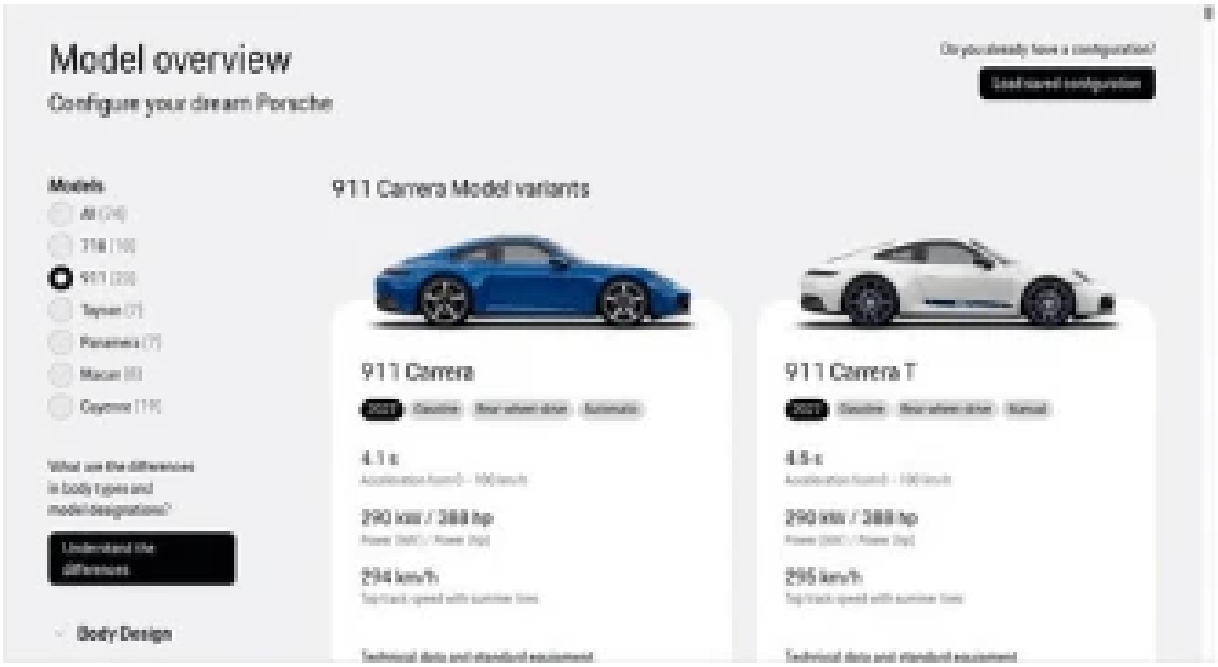


Figure 2. Canadian 911 overview: model-family filter, variant cards, technical highlights and Compare controls. Screenshot captured September 27, 2026.

SWOT snapshot

Strength	Variant filters, aligned highlights and a dedicated comparison path.
Weakness	A long model list raises scanning and selection effort.
Opportunity	Lotus can use a smaller, simpler comparison table for a shorter lineup.
Threat	Competitors may make decision-critical price/spec detail available earlier in the journey.

Task observation

The 911 overview shows acceleration, power and speed on cards and lets a visitor select two cars. A separate compare page also exposes Canadian starting prices. Centre Search and Finder offer downstream shopping routes.

Recommendations for Lotus

Priority 1 • Compare before configuring

Place a "Compare Lotus models" action beside "Explore" on the homepage and model pages. Present Emira, Eletre, Emeya and Evija by powertrain, body, everyday use, performance and availability; then compare variants in consistent units. Porsche demonstrates the value of aligned data, while McLaren demonstrates a focused range.

Priority 2 • Make the journey visible

Use a stable sequence: Models → Variant detail → Compare → Configure → Available cars / Test drive / Lotus Centre. Keep context when moving into separate tools; label the expected destination and show a route back to the selected model. The present Emira lineup mixes model, special edition and trim exploration.

Priority 3 • Organize ownership by task

Group Charging, Lotus Connect, handbooks, roadside assistance and contact under an "Owners" hub. Give prospective EV buyers a direct charging link from Eletre and Emeya. Keep heritage material under "Lotus story."

Priority 4 • Validate accessibility and mobile

Tested and verified that both are smooth and flawless ratios change depdnding on the device but all functionality remains the same

- Test headings and alt text in the rendered experience. The companion inventory's server-HTML flags are leads, not a complete conformance finding.
- Verify every compare filter, model card and configurator handoff with keyboard and screen reader.
- Check mobile card density, focus order, contrast over imagery and motion-control behavior against WCAG 2.2.

Decision rule

Keep a feature only if it helps a defined user task. Test whether visitors can name a suitable model, explain why, and find a next step without retracing their route.



Lotus - Competitive analysis

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Sources and disclosure

References • accessed September 27, 2026

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- https://www.mclaren.com/cars/uk_en/current-models/supercars
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How to read the findings

This is a qualitative comparison of sampled public desktop pages and three task paths. "Strength" and "weakness" are analyst judgments grounded in those observations. No user testing, mobile breakpoint evaluation, full customer-review study or formal accessibility audit was completed. Prices and current models can change; check linked sites before final presentation.

AI disclosure

Generative AI assisted with research organization, wording, analysis structure and document production. Screenshots were taken from official pages in the browser on September 27, 2026. Conclusions were reviewed and refined by the student before submission.